FREE CARD

My Emergency Contact Card

Wallet and bag cards with my name, address and contacts, a script for calling 112 or 999, Childline numbers and a practice card.

WHO IT IS FOR
Autistic children, young people and adults, with the parents, carers, teachers and SNAs who support them.

NCCA STAGE
All stages: Primary · Junior Cycle · Senior Cycle and LCA · Adults

Easy read

This card has my name and my phone numbers. If I need help, I show it. I can call 112 or 999.

How to use this resource

- Fill in page 2 with the person. Cut the cards out, laminate them, and keep one in a wallet, one in a school bag and one in a coat pocket.
- The **communication line** is optional. The person chooses whether to include it and what it says. Do not add it without asking.
- Learn the 112 and 999 script on page 3. Practise it with a toy phone or a real phone with the call turned off.
- Check the details every term. Update the card when a phone number or address changes.

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Version 1.0 · emergency-contact-card

My contact cards

Fill in the cards in pen or marker. Cut along the dotted lines. Keep one in each place you go.

My name

Name: _____

Address:

_____

Eircode: _____

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First contact (parent or carer)

Name: _____ Phone: _____ Relationship: _____

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Second contact

Name: _____ Phone: _____ Relationship: _____

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Health information (optional)

Allergies: _____ Medicine: _____ GP: _____

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How to help me (optional)

"I am autistic. I may find it hard to talk. Please be patient and give me time." Other: _____

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Emergency: 112 or 999

Gardaí, ambulance or fire.
Childline: 1800 66 66 66 · text 50101

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I keep my card in my bag.

My card has numbers for people I trust.

I call 112 or 999 in an emergency.

How to call 112 or 999

Call **112** or **999** if someone is in danger now, someone is hurt or very sick, there is a fire, or a crime is happening. Both numbers are free. They work from any phone.

1



Call 112 or 999

Press the numbers, then press call. Stay on the line.

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2



Say which service

"Gardaí", "ambulance" or "fire". They may ask you.

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3



Say where you are

Give your address or the place. Say the town.

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4



Say what happened

"Someone is hurt." "There is a fire." "I am not safe."

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5



Say your name

"My name is _____." Say your phone number if they ask.

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6



Stay on the line

Do not hang up. Wait. Do what they tell you. Help is coming.

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What to say: a script

You call. They answer and ask which service.



Ambulance, please.

They ask where you are.



I am at (my address), in (my town).

They ask what has happened.



My mum fell. She is on the floor and cannot get up.

They ask your name.



My name is _____. My phone number is _____.

You cannot speak well on the phone.



Hold the card. Say: "I am autistic. I find it hard to talk. Please be patient."

Childline and other numbers

Who	When	How
Emergency	Someone is in danger now	Call **112** or **999**
Childline	I am under 18 and need to talk, any time	Phone **1800 66 66 66** · Text **50101** · childline.ie
Text About It	I want to text someone, any time	Text **HELLO** to **50808**
Garda Confidential Line	I want to tell the Gardaí about something	**1800 666 111**
Parentline	A parent or carer needs support	**01 873 3500**

Practice card

Practise with an adult. Do not use a real phone call. Use a toy phone, or a phone in airplane mode. Practise at a calm time and then once a term.



Practice 1

My friend fell and hurt his leg. Which service do I ask for? What do I say?

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Practice 2

I smell smoke in the house. Where do I go? What number do I call?

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Practice 3

A stranger is following me and I am scared. Who can I call? What do I say?

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Practice 4

I am lost. How do I tell them where I am?

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Practice 5

I cannot talk well on the phone. What can I do?

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I know it

I can say my name, my address and my phone number. Tick when you can: ☐

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Notes for adults

- If you cannot speak on a call, stay on the line and make a noise or tap a key so they know you are there. You can also show an adult your card.
- The **communication line** ("I am autistic. I may find it hard to talk. Please be patient.") works like a communication passport. **It is the person's choice** whether it goes on their card, and what it says. Some people prefer to say "I am nonspeaking" or "I need extra time". Others want nothing. Ask, and respect the answer.
- Teach the **address and Eircode** with a song, a card or a rhyme. Check the person can find their card in their bag.
- Be careful what is on the card. If it could be seen by others, avoid health details, or use a folded card. Do not put the child's address on something visible, like a bag tag.
- Practise calmly and often. A child may know the number but freeze when stressed. A written script on the card helps.
- Do not tell children that calling 112 or 999 for no reason will get them into trouble. Say: "Call if you think someone is in danger. The call handler will help you decide."
- If your child may not be able to speak on a call, agree a plan with them in advance, such as showing the card to a nearby adult. Practise it.

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Curriculum links

NCCA and Department of Education alignment

- Primary SPHE (1999), strand **Myself**, strand unit *Safety and protection*, and strand **Myself and the Wider World**; supported by the Stay Safe programme.
- Junior Cycle SPHE (2023), Strand 2 **Making Healthy Choices**: personal safety and knowing how to get help.
- Senior Cycle SPHE (new specification published 2024) and LCA Social Education: independent living and personal safety.
- NCCA guidance on RSE for students with special educational needs: practise skills explicitly, using visual supports and scripts.

Universal Design for Learning

Every Autism & Me resource offers more than one way in: pictures and words together, an easy-read line, things to do with your hands, and scripts to practise. Keep the learning aim the same for everyone, and change the route. No diagnosis is needed to use any support in this resource.

Getting support in Ireland

Emergency

112 or 999 — Gardaí, ambulance or fire. Use it if someone is in danger now.

Childline (ISPCC)

Free, 24 hours: phone 1800 66 66 66, text 50101, or chat at childline.ie. For anyone under 18.

Text About It

Free text support any time: text HELLO to 50808.

An Garda Síochána

Contact your local Garda station, or 112 or 999 in an emergency. Garda Confidential Line: 1800 666 111.

Parentline

Support for parents and carers: 01 873 3500, parentline.ie.

Your school

Talk to the Designated Liaison Person (DLP) for child safeguarding, a class tutor or year head.

Autism & Me

Questions about this resource or training for your school: contactautismandme@gmail.com · autismandme.ie

If a child tells you something worrying

Stay calm. Listen, and believe them. Do not promise to keep it a secret. Write down what they said in their own words, with the date. Pass it on the same day: in a school, to the Designated Liaison Person (DLP); otherwise to Tusla. If anyone is in immediate danger, call 112 or 999. Follow *Children First: National Guidance for the Protection and Welfare of Children* (2017).

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